

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

No Show!

Q I have a number of players installed on my PC, such as Windows Media Player 10, RealOne Gold player, Hero Soft 2000, VCD Cutter 4.04, PowerDVD XP, and others. But none of these players are able to play .avi files. Different errors such as “no video data available”, “file is compressed”, “audio stream is not available” and so on turn up. The players are also unable to convert the .avi files to the .mpg format. But these files play easily on my friends’ computers, which have similar configurations.

Kajal Sarkar, via e-mail

A The problem you are facing is because you haven’t installed the codecs required to play compressed AVI files on your computer. There are codecs such as DIVX, XVID, MPEG-4, etc.

These codecs do not come bundled with Windows or the media players. To view your AVI files, you first need to install these codecs. You’ll then be able to view them in any media player such as Windows Media Player.

DIVX codecs can be downloaded from www.divx.com, and XVID codecs can be downloaded from www.koepi.org. Alternatively, you may install a codec pack such as the XP Codec Pack from www.xpcodecpack.com.

Alternatively, you can install VLC Player from www.videolan.org (or the *Digit* CD, June 2005) and use it to play your video files.

Still In Hibernation

Q Recently, when trying to shut down my computer, I chose to hibernate it. Nothing seemed wrong, but when I tried to restart it, neither the Windows 98 nor the XP OS booted. That there was no way to reinstall either OS only compounded the problem. How can I avoid this in the future?

R Panneer Selvam, via e-mail

A This problem occurs when the hardware—such as the video card—has drivers that do not properly support the hibernate feature. Another common cause for this problem is, when you hibernate the system and then make hardware changes such as adding or removing a hard drive or removable drive, the computer tries to restart in hibernate mode and cannot detect the changes.

You do not need to reinstall Windows to solve the problem. While the system boots, press F8 and opt to delete restoration data and boot into Windows to start Windows afresh.

Cell Phone As Modem

Q I have a Nokia 6630 cell phone and a postpaid connection that allows accessing the Internet, but I want to use my PC to surf. How can I do this?

Ashish, Assam

A To do this, you will first require the Nokia DKU-2 cable to connect your Nokia phone to your computer. Next, you need to install the drivers for this cable from the CD that came with the phone. If you don’t have this, you can download the drivers from the Nokia Web site.

The easiest way to set up and configure your Nokia 6630 as a modem is by installing the PC Suite. This includes the modem functionality and facilitates easy configuration of your phone as a modem in Windows. Another way is to download the GPRS settings wizard for the Nokia 6630 from the Nokia Web site and transfer it to your phone using the PC Suite and the DKU-2 cable or wireless connection.

Start the application and select the required settings. The wizard will detect the correct settings of your provider and save it to your phone. Some of the settings might not be available for your particular phone model and you may have to go to <http://snipurl.com/digitqa> and have them sent to your phone free of charge. If the GPRS settings wizard is unable to configure your phone properly, you will need to call the service provider for the settings.

Quiet Linux

Q I have a PC running Windows XP and Turbolinux. While using Turbolinux, the sound card does not work. Is the motherboard CD required to install the sound driver? I am new to Linux. Another problem I have is, I can’t find the boot.ini file on my C: drive despite selecting the ‘Show hidden files and folders’ options, and am not able to save it after modifying it in Notepad.

Tuku Dash, via e-mail

A It is very unlikely that the sound card drivers for Linux will be available on the motherboard CD, but you may as well give it a try. If they aren’t there, you can download them from <http://www.realtek.com.tw> and install them in TurboLinux. You may also try the ALSA driver from www.alsa-project.org.

To view and edit the boot.ini file, go to Control Panel and open ‘System Properties’. Navigate to the ‘Advanced’ tab and click on ‘Settings’ under ‘Startup and Recovery’. In the window that opens, click on ‘Edit’.

The boot.ini file will open in notepad. Click on ‘Cancel’ to close the previously opened window and close ‘System Properties’. You can now edit the boot.ini and save it, and the changes you made will be visible the next time the system boots.

